

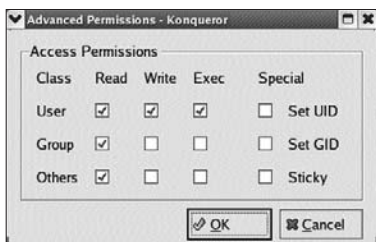
tory and enter it. Though the execute bit lets you enter the directory to add a file, you are not allowed to list its contents, unless you also have the read permissions to that directory.

With a combination of these permission, selective access can be granted to users such that their actions are strictly controlled.

Viewing File Permissions

You can right-click on a file or directory and choose *Properties*>*Permissions* tab.

There, you can see the permissions allowed to the Owner, User group, and Others for the file or directory. You can check or uncheck the read, write and execute options, and hence change the permissions. As with other things in Linux, it helps to be familiar with the command-line way of executing it too.



Viewing permissions in most distributions

In the command mode, just type in *"ls -l"*, and you can see the permissions along with other details of the file. In the listing that follows, you will see a set of seemingly random letters that precede the file owner. From the first 10 characters that appear at the start of the line, it is possible to see the ownership and permissions of the file.

The first character indicates if it is a directory or file: *"d"* means directory, and *"-"* means file. The next three letters denote the permission that the owner has.

An *"r"* in the second character means read permission

A *"w"* in the third character means write permission

An *"x"* in the fourth character means execute permission

A *"-"* means the corresponding permission does not exist.